Raquel Sousa - Lead Full-Stack AI Engineer & Technical Lead

Lurgan (NI - UK) • +447506433613 • raquel.sousa.wt@gmail.com • My Website • GitHub • LinkedIn

Professional Summary

Full-stack software engineer with 8+ years of experience building production SaaS platforms, now specialising in AI-powered application architecture. Currently serving as the sole technical lead for an AI-driven legal-tech platform, responsible for the entire product lifecycle: from system architecture and AI orchestration to DevOps and deployment. Deep expertise in React, TypeScript, and modern frontend ecosystems, combined with hands-on experience in RAG pipelines, multi-model LLM orchestration, AI agent frameworks, and local AI inference. Passionate about leveraging AI to solve real-world problems, with extensive self-directed research into model architectures, quantisation, and inference optimisation.

Key Skills

- **AI & Machine Learning:** RAG Pipelines · Multi-Model Orchestration · AI Agent Frameworks (Hermes, OpenWebUI, OpenCode) · Local AI Inference (vMLX, Ollama, LmStudio) · LLM Integration · Prompt Engineering · ComfyUI Workflows · Document AI & Verification · PR Agent
- **Frontend:** React · TypeScript · Next.js · Redux · Zustand · Tailwind CSS · CSS (any) · Storybook · Atomic Design · Formik · Zod · Yup · React Hook Forms · React Query · Responsive Design · Vite · Websockets
- **Backend & Cloud:** Node.js · Express · Go · PostgreSQL · MongoDB · Azure · Google Cloud Platform · Vercel · Serverless Functions · RESTful API · n8n · Python, OpenAI
- **DevOps & Infrastructure:** CI/CD Pipelines · GitHub Actions · Azure DevOps · Docker · Cloud Deployment · Automated & Integration Testing · Cloudflare · JIRA · Docker
- **Leadership & Methodology:** Technical Leadership · Solo Full-Stack Delivery · Agile/Scrum · Cross-Functional Stakeholder Management · Mentoring · Requirements Gathering · End-to-End Product Ownership
- **Other:** Playwright, Jest, Puppeteer,

Key Achievements

- Sole developer who architected and built an entire AI-powered legal-tech platform from scratch, now in production with multi-user collaboration
- Implemented RAG and multi-model AI orchestration in a legal domain, enabling AI-generated case reports and contextual document analysis
- Developed intelligent AI-driven file verification system to validate user-uploaded legal documents
- Successfully led React 19 migration for a production SaaS application, implementing concurrent features and performance optimisations
- Built 4+ production SaaS/platform applications from scratch across multiple companies
- Developed reusable component libraries reducing team development time by 30%
- Self-taught AI/ML practitioner - built custom agents, local inference systems, and orchestration pipelines independently

Career History

Lead Full-Stack AI Engineer: Law by Lawri (Current) *(August 2025 – Present)*

- Designed and built the entire AI-powered legal-tech platform from the ground up, serving as the sole developer across the full stack
- Architected a multi-user collaboration system with real-time capabilities, transforming the platform from a single-user tool into a collaborative workspace
- Implemented RAG (Retrieval-Augmented Generation) pipelines against legal document repositories, providing contextual AI assistance grounded in case-specific documentation
- Built multi-model orchestration layer within the application, intelligently routing tasks to different LLMs based on requirements (e.g., summarisation, analysis, generation)
- Developed AI agents for automated case creation, legal report generation, and intelligent document processing
- Created AI-powered file verification system to validate whether users uploaded the correct legal documents
- Designed and built comprehensive admin dashboards for platform management, analytics, and oversight

- Established full DevOps infrastructure across Azure and Google Cloud Platform, including CI/CD pipelines and GitHub Actions workflows
- Implemented unit testing and integration testing frameworks as a solo developer
- Led Agile/Scrum processes, technical requirement gathering, and product roadmap prioritisation
- Delivered the complete platform lifecycle independently: requirements, architecture, development, testing, deployment, and ongoing maintenance

Co-CEO & Co-Founder: Hiraeth Infinite (Current) *(October 2024 – Present)*
- Co-founded technology consultancy specialising in modern web applications, AI integration, and digital transformation solutions
- Provide end-to-end technical consulting: architecture, development, and deployment
- Deliver bespoke solutions leveraging modern frontend frameworks and AI capabilities

Senior Frontend Developer: Workstream *(July 2024 – September 2025)*
- Self-managed development of multiple proof-of-concept features, leading to production implementations
- Translated complex Figma designs into pixel-perfect React components with full responsiveness
- Architected and developed comprehensive component library using Next.js, TypeScript, and Tailwind CSS, reducing development time
- Led React 19 migration initiative, implementing new concurrent features and optimizing application performance
- Implemented robust form validation using Formik and Yup schemas for enterprise data collection
- Mentored 3 junior developers on React best practices and TypeScript implementation

Software Engineer: Safety NetAccess *(April 2024 – February 2025)*
- Led full-stack development of customer portal for RV park internet services using vanilla HTML, JavaScript, and Node.js (Express)
- Architected and spearheaded apartment management platform development, managing user authentication, package management, and billing integration
- Collaborated with backend teams to design MongoDB database architecture for Sage ERP integration and Salesforce connectivity
- Managed cross-functional stakeholder communications and technical requirement gathering
- Delivered end-to-end solutions from concept to deployment across multiple client projects

Frontend Developer: Edison365 *(August 2021 – April 2024)*
- Built enterprise SaaS application from the ground up using React, TypeScript, Redux, and microservices architecture
- Developed scalable component library with Storybook
- Collaborated closely with UI/UX designers, converting Figma prototypes into production-ready components
- Participated in full software development lifecycle
- Managed application state using Redux for optimal performance

Earlier Career

Software Engineer: Stark, Horley *(April 2020 – August 2021)*
Business Analyst: Maple Parking, Crawley *(July 2018 – April 2020)*
Junior Developer: Two Circles, London *(Sep 2017 – July 2018)*

Personal

- UK clean Drivers Licence
- Permanent Settled Status
- Interests: Technology, football, gaming, animals.